GUIDANCE NOTES — remove these notes before sending

Request for return of security deposit

When to use

- You are the tenant, the tenancy has ended, and the deposit (or part of it) has not been refunded, or deductions were made without explanation.

The rules in plain English

- The landlord may take a security deposit and undertakes to refund it, or what remains of it, at the end of the tenancy (Art. 20).
- The tenant returns the property in the condition received, except ordinary wear and tear or damage beyond the tenant's control (Art. 21).
- The law sets no fixed deadline for the refund beyond 'upon the expiry', so this letter asks for payment by a date you choose.

Attach your evidence

- Move-in checklist (T07) and move-out checklist (T08), dated photos, the key-handover receipt, and the final utility clearance if you have it.

How to deliver it

- The law defines a Notice as a written notification sent through a Notary Public, or delivered by registered mail, by hand, or by any other technological means approved by law (Law 26/2007 Art. 2, as amended by Law 33/2008).
- The law does not list which electronic means count. A Notary Public or registered mail gives the clearest proof of delivery.
- Keep a signed copy and the proof of delivery (notary record, registered-mail receipt, or the recipient's signed acknowledgement).

If it is not resolved

- Either party may take the matter to the Rental Disputes Center, which hears Dubai rent disputes (Decree 26/2013 Art. 6). The RDC filing fee for a money claim is 3.5% of the amount claimed, minimum AED 500, maximum AED 15,000, plus small service fees (RDC filing page).

What this template does not do

- This template is general information. It does not decide whether the rule applies to your situation, and it does not interpret your tenancy contract. Disputes are decided by the Rental Disputes Center (Decree 26/2013).

Legal basis (official sources, retrieved 2026-11-03)

- Law 26/2007 Art. 20 (deposit) and Art. 21 (return condition) — https://dlp.dubai.gov.ae/Legislation%20Reference/2007/Law%20No.%20(26)%20of%202007%20Regarding%20regulation%20between%20the%20lessor%20and%20the%20lessee.html
- Decree 26/2013 Art. 6 (Rental Disputes Center jurisdiction) — https://dlp.dubai.gov.ae/Legislation%20Reference/2013/Decree%2026%20of%202013.html
- RDC filing page (fees) — https://rdc.gov.ae/en/eservices/register-first-instance-lawsuit-rental/

The English texts are the official translations published by the Supreme Legislation Committee, Dubai; the Arabic text prevails in case of conflict.

General information and templates only, not legal advice. For your specific case consult a licensed legal practitioner in the UAE.

[Sender's name and address, or letterhead]

Date: **[DD Month YYYY]**

To: **[Landlord full name, as in the tenancy contract]**

From: **[Tenant full name] [— or: through authorised agent [agent name]**, under **[power of attorney / management agreement ref]**]

Property: **[unit no.]**, **[building]**, **[community]**, Dubai

Ejari no.: **[number]** · Tenancy contract dated **[date]**, expiring on **[expiry date]**

Request for return of the security deposit

Dear **[landlord name]**,

1. The tenancy of the property above ended on **[end date]**. I vacated on **[date]** and returned the keys, access cards and remotes on **[date][, and the move-out inspection took place on [date]]**.

2. Under Article 20 of Law No. 26 of 2007, the landlord undertakes to refund the security deposit, or what remains of it, at the end of the tenancy. I paid a security deposit of AED **[deposit amount]**.

3. I request:

☐ the full refund of AED **[deposit amount]**; or

☐ the refund of AED **[amount]**, together with an itemised statement and evidence (photos, quotes or invoices) for any deduction,

by **[payment date]**, to:

Account name	**[name]**
Bank	**[bank]**
IBAN	**[IBAN]**

4. I attach the move-in checklist dated **[date]**, the move-out checklist / photos dated **[date]**, and the key-handover receipt.

5. I would prefer to settle this directly. If we cannot agree, either of us may refer the matter to the Rental Disputes Center.

Yours sincerely,

Signature: _____

Name: **[full name]** · Capacity: **[Tenant]**

Phone / email: **[contact details]**

Proof of delivery (keep with your copy)

Method	Reference / evidence	Date
Registered mail	**[ref]**	**[date]**
Email to **[address]** — keep the sent copy	**[ref]**	**[date]**
By hand — landlord's signature	**[ref]**	**[date]**
Other: **[method]**	**[ref]**	**[date]**

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